

Galápagos

The Galápagos are a group of volcanic islands that lie about 621 miles (1,000 km) off the coast of Ecuador. There are several larger islands and many more smaller ones. Three major ocean currents meet here, bringing in lots of different sea animals.

Location

The Galápagos islands cluster around the equator in the Pacific Ocean. They have two seasons—a cool, dry season and a warm season.



PACIFIC OCEAN

Marchena Island

More lava lizards live in the Galápagos than any other reptile. They warm themselves on sunny rocks.

Bright-blue feet make this bird easy to spot. Female boobies have darker-blue feet than males.

Although it can't fly, this cormorant is a powerful swimmer and hunts eels and octopuses on the ocean floor.

Galápagos lava lizard

Blue-footed booby

Flightless cormorant

Galápagos hawk

Galápagos sea lion

This little penguin lives farther north than any other penguin species.

Galápagos penguin

The Galápagos hawk is very rare. It mostly eats giant centipedes, but also catches rodents and young iguanas.

This sea lion can move its back flippers independently, so it can "gallop" on land.

Marine iguana

Marine iguanas are the only lizards to swim in the ocean, where they look for seaweed to eat. Special glands clean salt from their blood, which they sneeze out!

Galápagos tortoise

This tortoise can grow up to 5 ft (1.5 m) long and weigh up to 500 lb (227 kg). Some of them are over 100 years old!

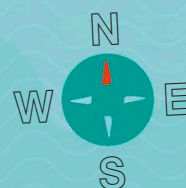
Sally Lightfoot crab

This bright-red crab earned its name by scuttling around at high speeds. It hides from birds by squeezing into tiny spaces between rocks.



Santa María Island

Española Island



SCALE

0 25 miles
0 25 kilometers



A marine iguana grazes on seaweed.